

TS EAS all-member meeting, 2026-08-10--12

Notetaker: Karin Bredenberg and Mary Samouelian, with help from AI (Claude)

Slide decks:

Participants

Name	10/8	11/8	12/8
Karin Bredenberg (Co-chair)	Y	Y	Y
Mary Samouelian (Co-chair)	Y	Y	Y
Ailie Smith	Y	Y	Y
Alexander Duryee	Y	Y	Y
Anais Lichtensztejn	Y	Y	Y
Andrew Janes	Y	Y	Y
Anna Björnsson (Standards liaison)	N	Y	Y
Bonface Odhiambo	N	N	N
Cory Nimer	Y	Y	Y
Elizabeth Russey-Roke	Y	Y	Y
Eric Sonnenberg	Y	N	N
Florence Clavaud (EGAD liaison)	Y	Y	N
Gerhard Müller (EAC Web liaison)	N	N	N
Glenn Gardner (EAD Web liaison)	N	N	N
Iris Lee	N	N	N
Kerstin Arnold	Y	Y	Y
Kevin Clair	Y	Y	Y
Kolbe Resnick	Y	Y	Y
Mark Custer	Y	Y	Y
Martha Tenney	N	N	N
Martin Critelli	N	N	N
Rhys Elia	Y	Y	Y
Silke Jagodzinski	Y	Y	Y
Venkat Srinivasan	Y	Y	Y
Yogita Sharma	Y	Y	Y
Ypapanti (Dia) Kytta	Y	Y	Y
李彦霖 Yanlin Li (Ellen)	Y	Y	Y

Day 1 Notes 2026-08-10

- Co-chairs reviewed meeting agenda, meeting norms, and the TS-EAS timeline. Also outlined goals for Day 1.
- Highlights from Day 1:
 - **The EAS suite of standards was officially released on July 31 and presented at SAA in New Orleans.** Co-chairs Mary Samouelian and Karin Bredenberg presented a hybrid session (approximately 90 attendees total, more online than in person), emphasizing that EAD, EAC-CPF, and EAC-F is a unified *suite* rather than standalone standards, and noted positive community reactions — including the Best Practice Guide, which was highlighted as a key living deliverable.
 - **Some concerns about SAA and community engagement.** Attendance at SAA was down (~600 fewer than last year) and TS-EAS members sense a broader disengagement from SAA due to staff departures and organizational challenges. This reinforced the central message that outreach will be the top priority going forward — including reaching practitioners who use systems like ArchivesSpace without ever touching the underlying XML, and focusing on practical implementation over technical encoding details.
 - **Education and awareness of the standards should be an ongoing discussion.** Ideas raised included engaging archival educators, following up with professors (e.g., at Indiana University), reconnecting with NAFAN-related efforts, and building crosswalks/bridges to other schemas (DC, DataCite, RiC) as suggested by Venkat.
 - **The committee introduced new members and reviewed its structure.** New members Anais (UK National Archives), Kevin Clair (Penn State), Boniface (Africa, pending connection), and Martha (ArchivesSpace) were welcomed, followed by roundtable introductions from the 20-person membership spanning the US West Coast to Australia. Notably, there is no early-career member this year.
 - **Next steps: rolling revisions and a member-driven planning process.** TS-EAS is now approved for a rolling revision cycle (minor revisions need Standards Committee approval; major ones need Standards + Council approval), which requires agility and more evenly distributed work across members. A draft document listing tasks that should be the focus of TS-EAS going forward was shared for members to review ahead of Day 2, when breakout groups will brainstorm priorities — including whether a new major revision is needed — with findings discussed on Day 3.

Day 2 Notes 2026-08-11

- **Review of the task list and the goals of the breakout group.** After recapping Day 1, the co-chairs presented the task list they've compiled over roughly three years. The task list, spanning governance, outreach, and technical questions, served as the foundational document driving the breakout discussions.
 - Karin stressed that with the suite mindset there will no longer be separate EAD / EAC-CPF / EAC-F teams — all three standards must be considered together in every change. What stays fixed: the two co-chairs (who retain ownership of the "different names, same concept" and "concept of entities" questions), the documentation subgroup (technical side of tag libraries and BPG), the editorial board (shepherding BPG articles), and member duties like attending three of four quarterly meetings. Everything else is up for discussion, with future groups intended to be self-governing rather than co-chair-attended.
 - Building on Elizabeth's comment for "bigger, fewer groups," the co-chairs emphasized that this is volunteer work done alongside day jobs and family — members should be able to step away for months if needed (just tell the co-chairs), no task should rest on one individual, and work must be distributed evenly so people feel like valued contributors rather than isolated.
 - Highlights of the task list include GitHub issue handling, RIC alignment, multilingual articles and translations, reusable presentation stubs, webinars, updating the wiki/microsite/governance rules, validation and tooling, date standards (with an ISO update pending), the un-validatable EAD2002 schema (raising the "only current version supported" design principle), crosswalks to be built via alliances with other standards bodies, and the big questions of whether the suite should eventually converge on a single shared tag library and even a single XML schema.
 - In framing the breakout exercise, the co-chairs encouraged members to think about pain points the teams had experienced and how to best move beyond those pain points.
- **Member-driven breakout brainstorming to shape the TS-EAS roadmap.** 18 participants were sent into four randomly assigned breakout groups for two hours. Groups were asked to review the full list and group similar tasks, suggest additions, removals, splits, or consolidations (with justification), optionally prioritize or sequence tasks, and recommend how each should be fulfilled — by an individual, a new task group, or the full membership. Detailed notes were required since each group reports out on Day 3 and the notes will feed directly into the creation of the TS-EAS roadmap.

Day 3 Notes 2026-08-12

- **All four breakout groups reported out, and despite different approaches they converged on remarkably similar themes.** Group 1 organized tasks into five themes — research/reach-out, outreach and awareness, community tool building, specific issue-solving, and "getting our house in order" — and named helping people adopt the standards as the top "gold" priority. Group 2 independently landed on five similar groupings (administration, conceptualization, technical implementation, editorial, and communication/engagement) and suggested possible new governance and promotion-coordination task forces. Group 3 focused on assigning responsibility and raised more questions than answers. Group 4 proposed exploding and flattening the current structure entirely: folding the documentation subgroup into the editorial board, designating a BPG editor for a unified voice, consolidating coordination under the co-chairs, and spinning off big items like RIC and translations into dedicated task forces.
- **Recurring cross-group ideas emerged that will likely shape the roadmap.** These included creating a data model or diagram of the EAS suite (possibly derived from the tag libraries rather than built from scratch), a reusable/translatable presentation template, a TS-EAS "secretary" or SAA liaison role (proposed by Group 3, seconded by Group 4), caution about pursuing a single shared schema or shared tag library right now, and drawing a clearer line between what TS-EAS officially owns versus what should be left to the community.
- **On RIC, the group leaned toward treating it as a research question rather than an immediate deliverable.** Group 3 argued RIC is still too experimental to commit crosswalk resources until there's clear community demand; Group 4 reframed crosswalking as "an intellectual exercise" that helps you understand your own standard better; and Group 2 suggested mapping to RIC's stable conceptual model rather than its ever-evolving ontology.
- **Communication infrastructure became the liveliest full-group discussion.** With members spread across many time zones, everyone agreed better asynchronous communication is needed, but the group wrestled with options: free Slack loses history after 30 days, SAA won't fund tools, GitHub holds decisions well but not the informal "hey, look at this" layer — and several members admitted GitHub itself remains confusing, sparking a well-received idea for a TS-EAS GitHub training. Co-chairs suggested a quick task force on consolidating communication channels; the reinforced theme was self-reliance from SAA wherever possible.
- **Next steps and farewells closed out the meeting.** The co-chairs will meet over the coming weeks (starting Aug 18 and 21) to draft a unified TS-EAS roadmap from all four groups' documents, deliver it to members by the October meeting,

and finalize it by year-end, flagging any major-revision needs to the Standards Committee. In the meantime: the annual report is due to SAA by end of August, members should keep promoting the suite (Karin's LinkedIn post has topped 900 views), contribute BPG articles, familiarize themselves with the new tag libraries during the intentional pre-October breather, and watch for reappointment deadlines. Kerstin also previewed EAG 3.0 — a "fourth EAS" for describing archival institutions — aligning with the suite this autumn. Warm thanks went to departing members Andrew, Cory, and Rebecca, with the meeting closing on the (Silke-coined, Mark-amplified) tagline: "Better and better each year."